

Come to Me, all who are weary and burdened

Matthew 11:28–30

Come to Me, all who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest.

*Take My yoke upon you, and learn from Me, for I am gentle and lowly in heart,
and you will find rest for your souls.*

For My yoke is easy, and My burden is light.

The invitation

- Come to Me — not to a system, a mood, or more effort. To a Person.
- All who labor / are heavy laden — the worn, the loaded, the ones still carrying what they cannot put down.
- I will give you rest — rest is given, not earned.
- Then the next step is not escape: Take My yoke and learn from Me.
- The rest He names is rest for your souls.

This sits next to 11:25–27: the Father is known through the Son. Coming to Jesus is how you come to the Father.

Abiding

Coming is the door. Remaining is the life.

- John 15:4–5 — abide in the Vine; apart from Him you can do nothing.
- John 14:6 — He is the way, the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father except through Him.
- John 16:33 — in the world you have thlipsis (trouble, pressure). In Him you have peace. He has overcome the world.
- The yoke is shared life: His pace, His teaching, His gentleness — not a second crushing load.

Weary is what the world produces. Connected is what the Son gives.

Applicability in a fallen world

The Kingdom is growing here, but the world still loads men.

- Weariness is often good things carried without Him: work, family, ministry, proving yourself, managing outcomes.
- Burden is often what you were never meant to own: other people's verdict, tomorrow's fear, the need to be enough.
- His rest does not mean the field is empty. It means the load is no longer yours alone.
- Gentle and lowly is the character of the One you walk with. Learn that — not only His words, but His heart.

-
- Easy yoke does not mean small life. It means the right Master. His burden is light because He carries what you cannot.

Practice: come as you are. Name the load. Take His yoke for this day. Stay.

Surprising connections — rest already promised, now present in the Son

- Jeremiah 6:16 — “Ask for the ancient paths... walk in it, and find rest for your souls.” Israel would not. Jesus uses the same words and is the path.
- Exodus — brick quotas without straw; Moses cries under the people; God gives Sabbath as gift, not prize. Christ is greater rest than a day off.
- Psalm 23 — He makes me lie down; He restores my soul. The Shepherd is now named.
- Isaiah 55:1–3 — “Come, everyone who thirsts... incline your ear, and come to Me; hear, that your soul may live.” Same verb: come.
- Isaiah 40:28–31 — the weary wait on the Lord and renew strength. Waiting becomes coming to the Son.
- Ruth 2–3 — rest under the wing of the kinsman-redeemer. Boaz prefigures the One who covers the exhausted.
- Hebrews 4:9–11 — a Sabbath rest remains for the people of God. Enter it by faith in the Son, not by finishing the work yourself.
- Zechariah 4:6 — “Not by might, nor by power, but by My Spirit.” The light yoke is Spirit-life, not self-might (same thread as Mighty in Spirit).

The symbols run one way: God has always been calling the loaded to Himself. In Jesus the call has a face, a yoke, and a promise that holds in this world.

Come.

Not when you are less tired.

Not when the burden is organized.

To Him.